

TAB 16



Board of Education Report

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Mr. Schmerelson, Ms. Goldberg - Observing October 6 as World Cerebral Palsy Day (Res-008-24/25) (Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District is committed to creating learning environments that promote inclusive education for students with disabilities to foster higher expectations for academic, social, and vocational outcomes;

Whereas, The District serves about 65,521 students with disabilities and provides 38 types of services while providing leadership, guidance, and support to schools to maximize learning for all students in a supportive and inclusive environment so that each student will contribute to and benefit from our diverse society;

Whereas, According to Johns Hopkins Medicine, cerebral palsy is the most common childhood physical disability and manifests in a range of motor symptoms from mild to severe, often leading to challenges in movement, balance, and posture;

Whereas, According to UCLA Health, approximately 10,000 babies are born each year with cerebral palsy in the United States, and it affects approximately 764,000 children and adults in total;

Whereas, Los Angeles County sees approximately 295 babies born each year with cerebral palsy;

Whereas, Communities of color have suffered through more challenging health outcomes due to a lack of affordable healthcare access and systemic barriers that affect millions of families;

Whereas, The District is committed to enhancing accessibility within schools for students with cerebral palsy and other motor disabilities, including the installation of ramps, accessible restrooms, toileting and hygiene supports, and other accessibility accommodations to ensure equal access to education for all students;

Whereas, Families around Los Angeles may rely on California Children's Services Medical Therapy Unit offices in Los Angeles, which emphasize the importance of access to early intervention and resources for informed decision-making regarding cerebral palsy management;

Whereas, The District has strategic partnerships with the Regional Centers throughout the region that provide assistance for students and families through training, case management, evaluations, and more;

Whereas, Cerebral palsy support groups and comprehensive online resources at regional centers in Los Angeles provide parents/caregivers with vital information and emotional support; and

Whereas, Families may have limited options for therapy services, primarily relying on California Children's Services Medical Therapy Units, which may be understaffed or geographically distant, with the alternative being private insurance or out-of-pocket payments; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District hereby proclaims October 6 as World Cerebral Palsy Day, celebrating the diversity and contributions of individuals with cerebral palsy, thus fostering a culture of acceptance, respect, and inclusion for all students;

Resolved further, That the Los Angeles Unified School District will initiate and emphasize awareness campaigns that expand knowledge of resources within schools and communities about cerebral palsy and other developmental disabilities, the challenges, and the methods to support individuals in educational settings through one event per school year and resources available in the Parent Center and at Parent-Teacher Association meetings, or other events;

Resolved further, That the Board encourages all qualified staff to promote the integration of inclusive practices and curriculum adaptations to meet the diverse needs of students with cerebral palsy, with greater knowledge and understanding of the Americans with Disabilities Act, Individuals with Disabilities Education Act, and Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act, ensuring they receive a quality education tailored to their abilities and strengths so they can effectively achieve positive outcomes;

Resolved further, That the District will instruct administrators at their respective schools to develop a plan by March 2025 to increase recess and lunchtime inclusivity through improved staff training, particularly yard supervision staff, but extended to all staff, on fostering better communication and providing inclusive activities for use during these times and teaching students about inclusive activities while engaging in recess and lunch;

Resolved further, That District Regional Superintendents, their teams, or a designee will review these plans and will provide feedback to principals finalizing with their approval;

Resolved further, That the Board recommends the Superintendent to implement training programs for teachers and staff on effectively supporting students with cerebral palsy and other developmental disabilities in the classroom, including strategies for inclusive teaching, communication techniques, legal requirements, and the usage of assistive technology; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the District shall invite all District schools, at all grade levels, to engage in ability awareness activities in the classroom, ideally incorporating them into lesson plans for students of all ages during the week preceding or following World Cerebral Palsy Day, recognizing its occurrence, at the discretion of school leadership.